Response to Reviewers' Comments

Forecasting Demand in Fictional City Networks with Example Models

Revised manuscript submitted to

Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies

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Dear Editor,

Thank you for handling the review of our manuscript, “Forecasting Demand in Fictional City Networks with Example Models” (Manuscript No. TRC-D-00-00002), and for the opportunity to submit a revised version.

We are grateful to both reviewers for their careful assessment and constructive suggestions. In the revision, we have focused on (i) methodological transparency, (ii) additional robustness checks, and (iii) a clearer discussion of the implications. A point-by-point response follows.

Yours sincerely,

John Doe
On behalf of all authors

Overview of Revisions

From	Comment	Addressed in	Page
Editor	E.1	Abstract	4
Reviewer 1	R1.1	Section 2.3	5
Reviewer 1	R1.2	Section 2.1; Figure 1	5
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Authors' Response to the Editor

Comment E.1

Please shorten the abstract to 250 words, as required by the journal.

Response: We thank the editor for this reminder.

The abstract has been shortened to 236 words.

Authors' Response to Reviewer 1

General Comments. This paper proposes a forecasting framework for a fictional city network. The topic is relevant and the dataset is valuable. However, the parameter choices and the validation strategy need further explanation.

Response: We sincerely thank the reviewer for the time and effort invested in evaluating our manuscript. We appreciate the recognition of the relevance of the topic and the value of the dataset. We have revised the manuscript accordingly and address each comment point by point below.

Comment R1.1

The values of the smoothing window w and the weights α_1 and α_2 are not reported.

Response: We thank the reviewer for this detailed comment on the parameter settings. All parameter values are now reported, together with their rationale:

> **Revised text (Section 2.3, p. 6, ll. 110–118)**
>
> The smoothing window was set to $w = 3$ observations. The weights were set to $\alpha_1 = 0.7$ and $\alpha_2 = 0.3$ ~~$\alpha_1 = \alpha_2 = 0.5$~~. This choice reflects the higher reliability of the volume measurements. ~~Default values were used.~~

AUTHOR CHECK: Confirm the final value of w before submission. (Remove this note, or compile with the `final` option.)

Comment R1.2

Two points regarding the dataset:

(a) The locations of the sensors are not shown.

(b) The choice of the study period should be justified.

Response: We appreciate these two helpful suggestions.

(a) A map of all sensor locations has been added as Figure 1.

(b) The study period is now justified at the beginning of Section 2.1.

Comment R1.3

The practical implications of the results remain limited.

Response: We thank the reviewer for this valuable suggestion.

Together with Reviewer 2, Comment 2, we have rewritten Section 5 to derive implications for network operators.

Authors' Response to Reviewer 2

General Comments. The manuscript addresses an interesting problem, but the novelty compared with existing models should be clarified.

Response: We sincerely thank the reviewer for the time and effort invested in reviewing our manuscript, and for the thoughtful and constructive feedback, which has helped us to improve the quality of the paper considerably. We have carefully considered all comments and suggestions, and we address each of them point by point below.

Comment R2.1

How were the weights in Equation (2) determined?

Response: We thank the reviewer for this valuable suggestion.

As explained in our response to Reviewer 1, Comment 1, the weights are now reported and justified. The new sensor map (see Comment R1.2(a)) also supports this choice.

Comment R2.2

The conclusion should distinguish case-specific findings from general lessons.

Response: Thank you for pointing this out.

Section 5 now contains two separate subsections: case-specific findings and transferable lessons.

Comment R2.3

Table 2 contains an inconsistency: the absolute change for sensor 7 is positive, but the percentage change is negative.

Response: We are grateful to the reviewer for carefully checking the numerical results. We apologise for this error and have corrected the sign in Table 2.